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Telescopic wrench

Abstract

A telescopic wrench includes an outer tube, an outer sleeve, and an inner rod. The first hole of the outer sleeve ring is fitted onto the outer tube, and the second hole of the outer sleeve provides peripheral contact with the rod section of the inner rod. The outer sleeve forms an external auxiliary fitting structure with the inner rod and outer tube. The telescopic wrench provides an improvement over known structures that are prone to loosening and noise during use. The telescopic wrench enhances the structural strength when subjected to operating forces.

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Background/Summary

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

1. Fields of the Invention
- (1) The present invention relates to a hand tool, and more particularly, to a telescopic wrench that is length adjustable.
2. Descriptions of Related Art
- (2) Currently, the industry has developed adjustable wrenches with variable lengths, such as Taiwanese New Model M429564, China invention CN111975699B, and the US invention US20170312906A1. These wrenches mainly use an outer sleeve to fit onto an inner tube. When adjusting the length, the inner tube and outer sleeve slide axially towards each other to shorten the overall length, and slide away from each other to elongate the overall length.
- (3) When the above adjustable wrenches are extended, the contact area between the outer sleeve and inner tube gradually decreases. This means that the force applied to the wrench needs to be borne by the contact area between the two, which not only raises concerns about insufficient structural strength due to force concentration, but also increases the likelihood of loosening and operational noise occurring at this point.
- (4) The present invention intends to provide a telescopic wrench to eliminate the shortcomings mentioned above.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

- (5) The present invention relates to a telescopic wrench and comprises an outer tube having a

passage defined axially therein. The outer tube has a first end and a second end on two opposite ends of the outer tube. An outer sleeve has a first hole and a second hole which is in communication with the first hole. The first hole of the outer sleeve is fitted to the first end of the outer tube. An inner rod has a work end and a rod section connecting to the work end. The rod section has an annular groove in which an elastic ring is engaged. The rod section is slidably engaged with the passage and the second hole. The elastic ring is compressed by contact with the inner periphery of the passage. The work end is exposed beyond the first end of the outer tube.

(6) The present invention also provides another telescopic wrench and comprises an outer tube having a passage defined axially therein. The outer tube has a first end and a second end on two opposite ends of the outer tube. An accommodating hole is defined in the first end of the outer tube and communicates with the passage. An end part includes an insertion section and an external section formed on two opposite ends thereof. The insertion section is inserted into the accommodating hole of the outer tube. The external section is located at the outside of the first end of the outer tube. A through hole is defined through the insertion section and the external section. The through hole communicates with the passage. An inner rod has a work end and a rod section connecting to the work end. The rod section is slidably engaged with the passage and the through hole. The elastic ring is compressed by contact with the inner periphery of the passage. The work end is exposed beyond the external section of the end part.

(7) The advantages of the present invention are that with the above structure in place, the outer sleeve and the end part can be securely connected to the first end of the outer tube. The second hole of the outer sleeve provides peripheral contact with the rod section of the inner rod, allowing the outer sleeve and the end part to form an external auxiliary fitting structure with the inner rod and outer tube. By doing so, the telescopic wrench provides an improvement over past known structures that are prone to loosening and noise during use. Furthermore, this enhances the structural strength of the wrench when subjected to operating forces.

(8) In addition, the elastic ring can undergo deformation under compressive forces, providing a smooth and dampened manual operation when adjusting the length of the telescopic wrench by pushing or pulling the outer sleeve or inner rod. Furthermore, this helps to reduce the impact of foreign objects and impurities from entering and affecting the operation of adjusting the overall length of the telescopic wrench.

(9) The present invention will become more obvious from the following description when taken in connection with the accompanying drawings which show, for purposes of illustration only, a preferred embodiment in accordance with the present invention.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) FIG. 1 is an exploded view of the telescopic wrench of the present invention;
- (2) FIG. 2 is a perspective view to show the telescopic wrench of the present invention;
- (3) FIG. 3 shows the length adjustment of the telescopic wrench of the present invention;
- (4) FIG. 4 is a cross sectional view, taken along line IV-IV in FIG. 3;
- (5) FIG. 5 is a cross sectional view, taken along line V-V in FIG. 3;
- (6) FIG. 6 is a cross sectional view, taken along line VI-VI in FIG. 2;
- (7) FIG. 7 is a cross sectional view, taken along line VII-VII in FIG. 2;
- (8) FIG. 8 shows that the sliding sleeve in FIG. 7 is pulled;
- (9) FIG. 9 shows that the inner rod in FIG. 8 is pulled;
- (10) FIG. 10 shows the movement of the ball when the inner rod in FIG. 9 is pulled;
- (11) FIG. 11 is a cross sectional view to show that the length of the telescopic wrench is adjusted;
- (12) FIG. 12 is an exploded view of another embodiment of the telescopic wrench of the present

invention;

(13) FIG. 13 is a perspective view to show the telescopic wrench in FIG. 12, and

(14) FIG. 14 is a cross sectional view, taken along line XIV-XIV in FIG. 13.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF THE PREFERRED EMBODIMENT

(15) Referring to FIGS. 1 to 6, the telescopic wrench 1 of the present invention comprises an outer tube 100 having a passage 110 defined axially therein. The outer tube 100 has a first end 101 and a second end 102 on two opposite ends of the outer tube 100. An outer sleeve 200 has a first hole 210 and a second hole 220 which is in communication with the first hole 210. The first hole 210 of the outer sleeve 200 is fitted to the first end 101 of the outer tube 100. An inner rod 300 has a work end 310 and a rod section 320 connecting to the work end 310. The rod section 320 has an annular groove 321 with which an elastic ring 322 is engaged. The rod section 320 is slidably engaged with the passage 110 and the second hole 220. The elastic ring 322 is compressed by contact with the inner periphery of the passage 110. The work end 310 is exposed beyond the first end 101 of the outer tube 100.

(16) The first hole 210 of the outer sleeve 200 can be securely connected to the first end 101 of the outer tube 100. The second hole 220 of the outer sleeve 200 provides peripheral contact with the rod section 320 of the inner rod 300, including that the rod section 320 slidably contacts the second hole 220, and when the rod section 320 is maintained still. This allows the outer sleeve 200 to form an external auxiliary fitting structure with the inner rod 300 and outer tube 100. By doing so, the telescopic wrench 1 provides an improvement over past known structures that are prone to loosening and noise during use. Furthermore, this enhances the structural strength of the wrench when subjected to operating forces.

(17) The elastic ring 322 is made by rubber which can be deformed when being compressed and returns to its initial status when the compression is removed. The elastic ring 322 provides a smooth and dampened manual operation when adjusting the length of the telescopic wrench 1 by pushing or pulling the outer tube 100 or inner rod 300. Furthermore, this helps to reduce the impact of foreign objects and impurities from entering and affecting the operation of adjusting the overall length of the telescopic wrench 1.

(18) The work end 310 of the inner rod 300 can be in various forms, such as an open-end wrench, a box-end wrench, a ratchet wrench, and the like, and is not limited to the appearance of the working end 310 as shown in the drawings. The outer sleeve 200 is made of a non-rigid material, such as plastic, and can be replaced with a new one and reinstalled when it is damaged.

(19) The outer sleeve 200 has an abutment surface 230 formed between the first hole 210 and the second hole 220. The abutment surface 230 is in contact with the end face of the first end 101 of the outer tube 100. The abutment surface 230, the inner periphery of the first hole 210 and the inner periphery of the second hole 220 are continuously connected to each other, thereby increasing contact area between the outer sleeve 200, the rod section 320 and the outer tube 100 to provide smooth operation.

(20) As shown in FIG. 6, the rod section 320 has a hole 323 defined radially in the outer periphery thereof. An elastic member 324 is elastically biased between an inner periphery of the hole 323 and a bead 325. The bead 325 contacts the passage 110. The hole 323 does not penetrate through the rod section 320 in radially direction. The hole 323 is located opposite to the work end 310 of the rod section 320. The elastic member 324 is a spring, and the bead 325 is a metal bead to provide smooth operation when adjusting the length of the telescopic wrench 1.

(21) As shown in FIGS. 1, 7 to 11, the rod section 320 has an axial groove 326 defined axially in the outer periphery of the rod section 320. Multiple dents 327 are spaced along the axial groove 326. The outer tube 100 has a bore 120 defined in the outer periphery thereof and communicating with the passage 110. A sliding sleeve 400 is slidably mounted to the outer tube 100 and has a protrusion 410 protruded from the inner periphery thereof. A ball 510 is located in the bore 120 and engaged with one of the dents 327. The protrusion 410 is located corresponding to the bore 120 and

restricts the ball **510** from dropping out from the bore **120**. The ball **510** is partially located in the bore **120** and partially located in the dent **327**. Therefore, the telescopic wrench **1** can be adjusted to be different lengths.

(22) The sliding sleeve **400** includes a first recess **420** and a second recess **430**. The protrusion **410** is located between the first and second recesses **420**, **430**. The outer tube **100** has a first ring **130** mounted to the outer periphery of the outer tube **100** and located in the first recess **420**. The outer tube **100** extends through a spring **520** which is located between the first ring **130** and a first end face **440** on one of two sides of the protrusion **410** of the sliding ring **400**. When the sliding sleeve **400** is pulled toward the second end **102**, the protrusion **410** of the sliding sleeve **400** is removed from the bore **120**. When the second recess **430** of the sliding sleeve **400** is moved to the bore **120**, either the inner rod **300** or the outer tube **100** can be easily moved. The inner periphery of the bore **120** can remove the ball **510** from the dent **327**, and the ball **510** partially exposed beyond the bore **120** and is located corresponding to the second recess **430**. Therefore, the ball **510** can be moved along the axial groove **326** until the ball **510** is engaged with another dent **327** to complete the length adjustment of the telescopic wrench **1**. The first ring **130** in this embodiment is a C-clip.

(23) A second ring **140** is mounted to the outer periphery of the outer tube **100** and is spaced from the first ring **130**. When the sliding sleeve **400** is moved toward the first end **101**, the second ring **140** contacts the second end face **450** of another one of two sides of the protrusion **410** of the sliding sleeve **400** so as to restrict the sliding sleeve **400** from disengaging from the outer tube **100** from the first end **101**. The second ring **140** in this embodiment is a C-clip.

(24) As shown in FIGS. **8-11**, when adjusting the length of the telescopic wrench **1**, the user holds the outer tube **100** by one hand, and the other hand pulls the work end **310** of the inner rod **300** in the direction away from the outer tube **100**. Alternatively, the user may hold the work end **310** of the inner rod **300** by one hand, and the other hand pulls the outer tube **100** in the direction away from the inner rod **300**. The user can also hold the outer tube and the work end **310** of the inner rod **300** by both of his/her hands and pull in two opposite directions.

(25) As shown in FIG. **7**, the outer sleeve **200** has an entrance hole **240** which communicates with the first hole **210** of the outer sleeve **200**. One end of the sliding sleeve **400** is normally extended into the entrance hole **240**. The outer sleeve **200** does not contact the sliding ring **400**. This arrangement does not affect the movement of the sliding sleeve **400**.

(26) As shown in FIGS. **12-14**, another embodiment of the present invention is disclosed, the differences from the first embodiment are that an accommodating hole **160** is defined in the first end **101** of the outer tube **100** and communicates with the passage **110**. An end part **600** includes an insertion section **610** and an external section **620** formed on two opposite ends thereof. The insertion section **610** is inserted into the accommodating hole **160** of the outer tube **100**. The external section **620** is located at the outside of the first end **101** of the outer tube **100**. A through hole **630** is defined through the insertion section **610** and the external section **620**. The through hole **630** communicates with the passage **110**. The work end **310** is exposed beyond the external section **620**.

(27) Furthermore, the end part **600** includes a contact face **640** formed between the insertion section **610** and the external section **620**. The contact face **640** contacts the end face of the first end **101** of the outer tube **100**. Therefore, the end part **600** provides the telescopic wrench **1** with smooth and stable operation.

(28) While we have shown and described the embodiment in accordance with the present invention, it should be clear to those skilled in the art that further embodiments may be made without departing from the scope of the present invention.

Claims

1. A telescopic wrench comprising: an outer tube having a passage defined axially therein, the outer tube having a first end and a second end on two opposite ends of the outer tube, an outer sleeve having a first hole and a second hole which is in communication with the first hole, the first hole of the outer sleeve being fitted to a first end of the outer tube, the outer sleeve having an abutment surface formed between the first hole and the second hole, the abutment surface being in contact with an end face of the first end of the outer tube, an inner rod having a work end and a rod section connecting to the work end, the rod section having an annular groove with which an elastic ring is engaged, the rod section being slidably engaged with the passage and the second hole, the elastic ring being compressed by contact with an inner periphery of the passage, the work end being exposed beyond the first end of the outer tube.
2. The telescopic wrench as claimed in claim 1, wherein the rod section has a hole defined radially in an outer periphery thereof, an elastic member elastically biased between an inner periphery of the hole and a bead, the bead contacts the passage.
3. The telescopic wrench as claimed in claim 1, wherein the rod section has an axial groove defined axially in an outer periphery of the rod section, multiple dents are spaced along the axial groove, the outer tube has a bore defined in an outer periphery thereof and communicating with the passage, a sliding sleeve slidably mounted to the outer tube and has a protrusion formed to an inner periphery thereof, a ball is located in the bore and engaged with one of the dents, the protrusion is located corresponding to the bore and restricts the ball from dropping out from the bore.
4. The telescopic wrench as claimed in claim 3, wherein the sliding sleeve includes a first recess and a second recess, the protrusion is located between the first and second recesses, the outer tube has a first ring mounted to the outer periphery of the outer tube and located in first the recess, the outer tube extends through a spring which is located between the first ring and a first end face on one of two sides of the protrusion of the sliding ring, a second ring is mounted to the outer periphery of the outer tube and is spaced from the first ring, the outer sleeve has an entrance hole which communicates with the first hole of the outer sleeve, one end of the sliding sleeve is normally extended into the entrance hole, the outer sleeve does not contact the sliding ring.
5. A telescopic wrench comprising: an outer tube having a passage defined axially therein, the outer tube having a first end and a second end on two opposite ends of the outer tube, an accommodating hole defined in the first end of the outer tube and communicating with the passage, an end part including an insertion section and an external section formed on two opposite ends thereof, the insertion section inserted into the accommodating hole of the outer tube, the external section is located at an outside of the first end of the outer tube, a through hole defined through the insertion section and the external section, the through hole communicates with the passage, an inner rod having a work end and a rod section connecting to the work end, the rod section being slidably engaged with the passage and the through hole, an elastic ring being compressed by contact with an inner periphery of the passage, the work end being exposed beyond the external section of the end part.
6. The telescopic wrench as claimed in claim 5, wherein the end part includes a contact face formed between the insertion section and the external section, the contact face contacts an end face of the first end of the outer tube.
7. The telescopic wrench as claimed in claim 5, wherein the rod section has a hole defined radially in an outer periphery thereof, an elastic member elastically biased between an inner periphery of the hole and a bead, the bead contacts the passage.
8. The telescopic wrench as claimed in claim 5, wherein the rod section has an axial groove defined axially in an outer periphery of the rod section, multiple dents are spaced along the axial groove, the outer tube has a bore defined in an outer periphery thereof and communicating with the passage, a sliding sleeve slidably mounted to the outer tube and has a protrusion formed to an inner periphery thereof, a ball is located in the bore and engaged with one of the dents, the protrusion is

located corresponding to the bore and restricts the ball from dropping out from the bore.

9. The telescopic wrench as claimed in claim 8, wherein the sliding sleeve includes a first recess and a second recess, the protrusion is located between the first and second recesses, the outer tube has a first ring mounted to the outer periphery of the outer tube and located in the first recess, the outer tube extends through a spring which is located between the first ring and a first end face on one of two sides of the protrusion of the sliding ring, a second ring is mounted to the outer periphery of the outer tube and is spaced from the first ring, the outer sleeve has an entrance hole which communicates with the first hole of the outer sleeve, one end of the sliding sleeve is normally extended into the entrance hole, the outer sleeve does not contact the sliding ring.
